

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

In Feature, we delve into the journey and challenges of UPI, in Desire, we list out some of the coolest gadgets that launched recently, in Temptation, we review some interesting books, and much more!



Marching towards inclusivity

To show increased support for Asian businesses and stand against violent acts targeting the Asian community, Google is adding a feature that would let self-identified Asian-owned businesses tag themselves on its searches and maps.

<https://dgit.in/GMaps>

WHAT'S NEW

Ukrainian researcher claims PF data leak of 28 crore Indians

Hackers leaked about 28 crore consumers' Provident Fund (PF) data in the beginning of August. Bob Diachenko, a cybersecurity researcher from Ukraine, discovered this on August 1. He found that Universal Account Numbers (UANs), names, marital status, Aadhaar details, gender, and bank account details were released online. He found two clusters of leaked data on two different internet portals. These IPs were hosted on Microsoft's Azure cloud storage service. The researcher said he was immediately certain he was looking at something big and important. He was not able to find who owned the data. Both the IP addresses were hosted on



Microsoft's Azure. Both were also Indian based, but he couldn't obtain more information via a reverse DNS

analysis. Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) was tagged in a post on Twitter disclosing the leak. In response, CERT-In requested the report of the hack in an email. After that, within 12 hours of his tweet, both IP addresses were taken down. According to Diachenko, no company or agency has taken responsibility for the leak yet. <https://dgit.in/PFDataLeak>

Standard charging ports in India!

The European Union passed legislation urging tech brands to provide consumers with a common charging port for all their devices by June of this year. Not just for charging, but for connectivity and data transfer as well. As per a recent News18 report, the Indian Government is likely to adopt similar legislation and is currently planning to set a committee meeting for the



same. At present, consumer electronic brands use a variety of ports for charging, data transfer, and connectivity. While laptops and cameras have proprietary

ports for inputs and outputs, smartphone brands like Apple use lightning ports for charging. If the motion is passed, it will urge the consumer electronic brands to set common charging, input, and output ports for all devices. The committee for the same will be held on the 17th of August to understand and set the decided legislation legally.

<https://dgit.in/UGetUSBc>



Twilio hacked in a phishing attack

US-based enterprise software vendor company Twilio has said it had been hacked as someone gained "unauthorised access" to information related to its customer accounts. Twilio has more than 150,000 customers, including Facebook and Uber.

<https://dgit.in/Twilio>



DuckDuckGo disables Microsoft web trackers

DuckDuckGo is following through on its pledge to protect user privacy by finally blocking Microsoft tracking scripts. DuckDuckGo plans to build an advertisement conversion tracking protocol in the future as well.

<https://dgit.in/DuckDuckNo>



89 per cent of Indians want a 5G upgrade

As India gears up to usher in the 5G era, a new report has shown that 89 per cent of consumers wish to upgrade to 5G network in India while 48 per cent would upgrade to 5G even if it calls for switching service providers.

<https://dgit.in/5Gforyou>